UV Mask Maker V4 User Manual

This manual provides instructions, workflows, and configuration details for **UV Mask Maker V4**, a Unity editor extension designed to create, edit, and apply mask textures directly on 3D models within the Unity Editor.

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1. Product Overview

1.1 Purpose and Summary

UV Mask Maker V4 enables users to select polygons and UVs or hand-paint directly on 3D meshes (such as VRChat avatars and clothing) in the SceneView to generate and assign black-and-white mask textures.

By eliminating round-trips between external image editing software (e.g., Photoshop, CLIP STUDIO PAINT) and Unity, you can inspect changes in real time and complete the entire workflow—from mask generation to material assignment—within the Unity Editor.

1.2 System Requirements and Prerequisites

- **Supported Environment**: Unity 2022.3 LTS or later
- **Target Objects**: GameObjects containing `SkinnedMeshRenderer` or `MeshRenderer` components
- **Supported Shaders**: Shaders featuring mask texture input slots (e.g., lilToon, Poiyomi Toon Shader, Sunao Shader)
- **Mesh Requirements**: Target meshes must have valid primary UV layout (UV0)

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2. Interface Overview and Component Layout

The interface is structured into the following operational areas to maximize workflow efficiency:

```
+-------------------------------------------------------------------+
| Main Window (EditorWindow / Tool Tab)                             |
| [Target Renderer Picker] [Start / Stop Editing]                   |
| +---------------------------------------------------------------+ |
| | UV View (2D UV layout preview / picking / painting)           | |
| +---------------------------------------------------------------+ |
| [Export Settings: File Name / Resolution / Channel / Advanced]    |
| [Export Button (Ctrl+Enter)]                                      |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------+

In SceneView:
  - Floating Toolbar (Draggable, can be placed anywhere in SceneView)
  - Radial Menu (Summoned directly under cursor by holding C)
  - Notification Panel (Toast message with Apply button upon export)
```

2.1 Main Window (Tool Tab)

Opened via top menu: **`dennokoworks`** > **`MaskMaker V4`**.

- **Target Object Selection**: Specifies the active Renderer and starts/ends editing sessions.
- **UV View**: Allows direct polygon selection and brush painting on the 2D UV layout.
- **Export Settings**: Configures texture file names, resolutions, target color channels, and edge dilation (padding).
- **Language Switch**: Toggles the display language between Japanese (`JA`) and English (`EN`) in the top-right header.

2.2 SceneView Floating Toolbar

Appears inside the SceneView when an editing session begins. Can be repositioned by dragging.

- **Mode Toggle**: Switches between Selection Mode and Paint Mode.
- **Selection Granularity**: Toggles between Island, Part, and Face modes.
- **Paint Tools**: Selects between Brush, Rectangle fill, Lasso fill, and Eraser.
- **Utilities**: Toggles Symmetry Editing (X-Mirror), Target Isolation, and X-Ray (Translucent) display.
- **History & Actions**: Executes Undo, Redo, Clear Selection, and Quick Export.

2.3 Radial Menu

Holding the `C` **key** in the SceneView summons a circular context menu directly under your mouse cursor. Move the cursor toward the desired tool and release the key to switch tools instantly without moving your cursor to screen edges.

2.4 Notification Panel (Toast UI)

Appears temporarily on-screen upon completing an export or specific operations. Clicking the `Apply` button inside the notification automatically assigns the exported mask texture to the appropriate material slot.

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3. Basic Workflow (Quick Start)

The standard procedure for selecting mesh regions, exporting a mask, and applying it to a material:

```
[Select in Hierarchy] → [Right-Click to Start] → [Click Mesh to Select] →
[Ctrl+Enter to Export] → [Click Apply]
```

Step 1: Start Editing

1. In the Hierarchy, select the GameObject containing the mesh you wish to mask (e.g., outfit or avatar component).
2. Right-click the object and select `dennokoworks` > `MaskMaker V4`. *(Alternatively, open the main window and click the **Start** button).*
3. Non-target scene objects are temporarily hidden (isolated), and the SceneView camera automatically frames the target mesh.

Step 2: Define Mask Areas

1. In the SceneView, **Left-Click** on the mesh surface you want to mask:

- Clicking an unselected region adds it to the mask.
- Clicking an already selected region removes it.
- **Double-Click** to select an entire connected mesh component.

2. For symmetrical components (e.g., sleeves or shoes), press the `X` **key** to enable Symmetry Editing. Selecting one side automatically selects the corresponding geometry on the opposite side.

Step 3: Export and Assign to Material

1. Press `Ctrl + Enter` (or click the Export button on the main window / floating toolbar).
2. Once the image is generated, a notification toast appears on-screen.
3. Click `Apply` within the notification. The tool inspects shader properties and assigns the texture to the appropriate mask slot. *(If multiple candidate slots exist, choose the desired slot from the displayed list).*

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4. Feature Summary Table

Category	Feature	Description
Selection	**Click Selection**	Toggle selection on and off by clicking mesh regions
	Drag Selection	Continuously select or deselect polygons along the cursor path
	Part Selection	Double-click to select an entire connected geometric component
	Granularity Switching	Switch selection scale between Island, Part, and Face modes
	Grow and Shrink	Shift + Mouse Wheel to expand or shrink the selection across adjacent faces
	Symmetry Editing	Press X to mirror selections and paint strokes across the mesh's X-axis
	Select All / Invert / Clear	Ctrl+A to select all, Ctrl+I to invert selection, and Clear via menu
Painting	**Paint Tools**	Brush, Rectangle fill, Lasso fill, and Eraser tools
	Brush Size Adjustment	Ctrl + Right-Drag to dynamically adjust brush radius under the cursor
	Instant Eraser	Hold Ctrl while painting with any tool to temporarily erase
View	**Mesh Mask Overlay**	Renders mask areas and UV seam lines directly on the 3D surface
	UV View	Inspect and edit 2D UV layouts with direct selection and painting
	Base Texture Overlay	Overlays the original model texture as the background of the UV View
	Target Isolation	Temporarily hides unselected scene objects during editing
	X-Ray View	Renders geometry translucent to view and select occluded backfaces

Category	Feature	Description
	Pause Picking	Hold Space to suspend tool inputs and use default camera controls
Export	**Mask Texture Export**	Generates linear black-and-white PNG mask textures at specified resolutions
	Padding (Dilation)	Dilates mask boundaries outward to prevent texture filtering seams
	Inverted Mask Export	Exports inverted masks, or saves normal and inverted versions simultaneously
	Channel Packing	Injects masks directly into specific channels (R, G, B, or A) of existing textures
	Safe Overwriting	Re-exporting overwrites previous files so linked materials update automatically
	Material Auto-Apply	1-click shader slot assignment from post-export notification toasts
	UV Wireframe Export	Exports wireframe layout PNG images for external paint programs
	Import Mask Image	Drag and drop black-and-white images into the UV View to merge into paint
Workflow	**Radial Menu**	Hold C to summon a circular tool picker under the cursor
	SceneView Toolbar	Floating, movable toolbar inside the SceneView
	Unified Undo / Redo	Full history tracking for selections, paint strokes, and settings via Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y
	Auto-Save & Restore	Persists edit states across scene changes, recompiles, and Unity restarts
	Multi-Language Support	Instant toggle between Japanese (`JA`) and English (`EN`)

5. Detailed Feature Guide

5.1 Selection Mode

Selection Mode assigns mask coverage based on the underlying polygon geometry. Press `Tab` to switch between Selection Mode and Paint Mode.

Selection Granularity

Switch using keys `1` / `2` / `3`, the toolbar, or the Radial Menu:

- **1: Island**: Selects by UV island boundaries (seams). Recommended for quickly selecting distinct fabric or garment sections.
- **2: Part**: Selects connected geometric mesh elements. Double-clicking any polygon triggers the same action.

- **3: Face**: Selects individual triangle polygons. Useful for trimming small sections from an island or part.

Note: Changing the selection granularity preserves your active selection.

Selection Controls

- **Smart Toggle**: Clicking unselected areas adds them; clicking selected areas removes them.
- **Drag Selection**: Drag with the left mouse button held down to select or deselect all geometry under the cursor path.
- **Modifier Keys**:
  - `Shift` + Click / Drag: Forces addition to the selection.
  - `Ctrl` + Click / Drag: Forces removal from the selection.
- **Grow and Shrink**:
  - `Shift` + Mouse Wheel Up: Expands the selection outward by one adjacent polygon step.
  - `Shift` + Mouse Wheel Down: Contracts the selection inward by one step.
- **Symmetry Editing (X-Mirror)**:
  - Press `X` to toggle symmetry.
  - Polygons mirrored across the mesh's local X=0 plane are selected or deselected simultaneously.

5.2 Paint Mode

Paint Mode provides freehand drawing capabilities independent of polygon topology. Press `Tab` to toggle between Paint Mode and Selection Mode.

Paint Tools

Switch using the Radial Menu (hold `C`) or hotkeys:

- **Brush (`B`)**: Projects a circular brush onto the 3D surface.
- **Rectangle (`M`)**: Fills a rectangular screen-space bounding box.
- **Lasso (`L`)**: Fills an arbitrary freehand enclosed region.
- **Eraser (`Shift + B`)**: Erases painted strokes.

Brush Size Adjustment

- `Ctrl` **+ Right-Drag**: Drag horizontally on the mesh to smoothly resize the brush circle under your cursor.
- `[` **/** `]` **Keys**: Press `[` to decrease and `]` to increase brush diameter.

Instant Eraser

Holding `Ctrl` **while painting with any tool temporarily switches to the eraser**. Releasing `Ctrl` returns to the active tool.

5.3 UV View

The UV View in the center of the main window enables inspection and editing directly on the flattened 2D UV layout.

- **Unified Navigation & Controls**: The same selection and paint tools operate identically in the UV View as in the 3D SceneView.
- **Canvas Navigation**:
  - Mouse Wheel: Zoom in and out
  - Middle Mouse Drag (or Alt + Left Drag): Pan canvas
  - Focus button (top-right) or `F` key: Reset zoom and center UV layout
- **Base Texture Overlay**:
  - Click the texture icon in the top right of the UV View to display the model's active texture in the background for visual alignment.
- **Importing Mask Images**:
  - Drag and drop any black-and-white texture file into the UV View to import dark areas directly into the paint layer.

5.4 Export and Material Application

Export textures from the main window's export panel or by pressing `Ctrl + Enter`.

Export Parameters

- **File Name**: Defaults to `{RendererName}_mask.png`.
- **Resolution**: Select from 512, 1024, 2048, or 4096 pixels.
- **Channel Packing**:
  - Export as a standalone grayscale texture or pack into a specific channel (R, G, B, or A) of an existing texture.
- **Advanced Settings**:
  - **Invert**: Inverts black and white values.
  - **Padding (Dilation)**: Dilates mask boundaries outward by a specified number of pixels. This prevents mipmap filtering artifacts and seam bleeding at UV edges.
  - **Save Inverted Too**: Generates both normal and inverted versions in one operation.

Material Assignment and Safe Overwriting

- Re-exporting an existing target overwrites the previous texture file. Because materials reference this file on disk, the material automatically updates in the scene without manual reassignment.
- Clicking `Apply` in the completion toast automatically analyzes shader properties and assigns the file to the correct mask slot.

5.5 UV Wireframe Export

Export UV wireframe layout images for reference in external painting applications.

1. Click the **Camera icon button** in the top right of the UV View.
2. The "Export UV Layout" configuration dialog opens.
3. Configure settings:
   - **Resolution**: 512 to 4096
   - **Render Elements**: Toggle polygon lines, seam lines, selection filter, and island coloring
   - **Background**: Transparent background or base texture overlay

- **Color Settings**: Custom colors for wireframes, seams, and fills

4. Click `Export` to save the PNG image into your project.

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6. Shortcut Key Reference

Hotkey	Category	Action
`Tab`	Mode	Switch between Selection Mode and Paint Mode
`Left Click`	Selection	Toggle selection on and off
`Double Click`	Selection	Select or deselect entire connected component
`Left Drag`	Selection / Paint	Continuous drag selection or brush painting
`Shift` + **Click / Drag**	Selection / Paint	Force Add to selection (Force paint in Paint Mode)
`Ctrl` + **Click / Drag**	Selection / Paint	Force Remove from selection (Instant Eraser in Paint Mode)
`Ctrl` + **Right-Drag**	Paint Settings	Interactively adjust brush radius under cursor
`[` / `]`	Paint Settings	Decrease / Increase brush size
`Shift` + **Mouse Wheel**	Selection Assist	Expand (Wheel Up) / Shrink (Wheel Down) selection
`X`	Selection Assist	Toggle Symmetry Editing (X-Mirror)
`1` / `2` / `3`	Granularity	Switch selection granularity (1: Island / 2: Part / 3: Face)
`B`	Tool Picker	Select Brush tool
`M`	Tool Picker	Select Rectangle Fill tool
`L`	Tool Picker	Select Lasso Fill tool
`Shift + B`	Tool Picker	Select Eraser tool
`C` **(Hold)**	Interface	Summon Radial Menu under cursor
`Space` **(Hold)**	Control Assist	Suspend tool input (use default camera controls)
`Ctrl + A`	Selection Action	Select all polygons
`Ctrl + I`	Selection Action	Invert selection
`Ctrl + Z`	History	Undo previous action
`Ctrl + Y`	History	Redo undone action
`Ctrl + Enter`	Export	Quick export mask texture
`F`	View Navigation	Center and reset UV View zoom

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7. Notes and Troubleshooting

Frequently Asked Questions

Q. Applying the exported mask does not change the model appearance in the scene.

- **A.** Check the following:
  1. Ensure that the corresponding shader feature utilizing masks (e.g., lilToon's "Outfit Mask", "Alpha Mask", or "Rimlight Mask") is enabled on the material.
  2. If the mesh contains multiple material slots, verify that the mask was applied to the intended submesh material.
  3. Verify that the texture import settings (such as `Alpha Source` or `sRGB (Color Texture)`) match shader requirements (the automatic `Apply` action sets recommended values automatically).

Q. Dark or light fringes (bleeding) appear along UV seams in the distance.

- **A.** This is typically caused by mipmap downsampling blending the mask edge with background pixels. In the main window, open **Advanced Settings > Padding** and increase the padding value (e.g., 8–16 px) before re-exporting. Dilating the boundary colors outward eliminates seam bleeding.

Q. Symmetry Editing (X key) does not affect the opposite side.

- **A.** Consider the following factors:
  1. Symmetry Editing detects pairs relative to the mesh's local coordinate center (X = 0). If the model's pivot is offset from its visual centerline, symmetric pairs cannot be identified.
  2. Asymmetrical mesh geometry or mismatched UV mapping between left and right sides cannot be mirrored automatically. In this scenario, disable Symmetry Editing and select the regions individually.

Q. What happens if Unity is closed unexpectedly or scripts recompile during editing?

- **A.** Edit states (selection buffers and paint layers) are automatically cached to persistent disk storage. When reopening the project or returning after script compilation, selecting the same target object restores your work session seamlessly.

Q. Can I undo an accidental selection clear?

- **A.** Yes. Press `Ctrl + Z` to revert. All actions—including selections, brush strokes, and clearing—are recorded in a unified undo stack.